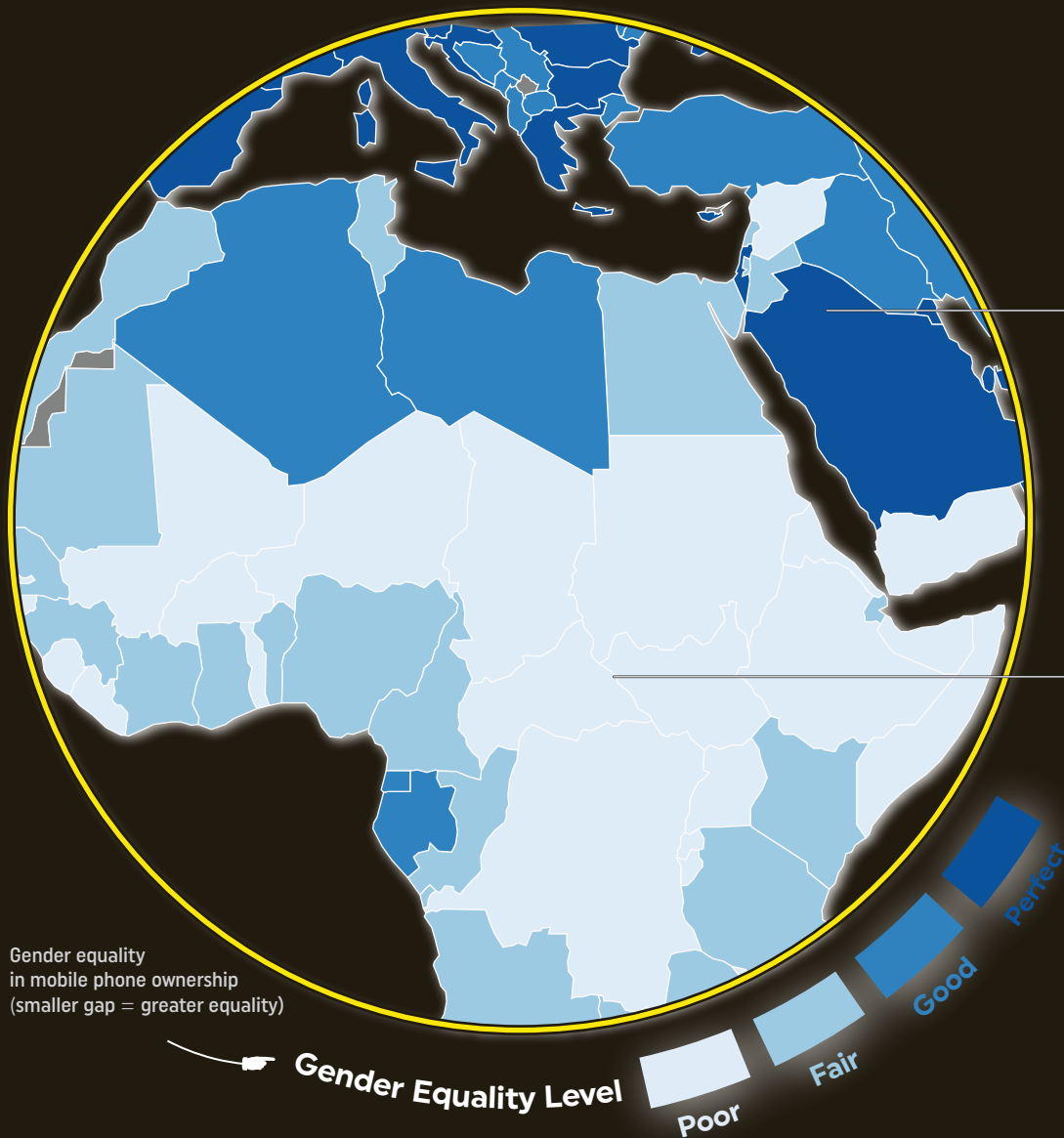




What drives the gender gap in mobile phone ownership?

Lowest Gender Gap Area

96.1%

Proportion of women who own mobile phones

93.2%

Proportion of women who use the Internet

Cultural Norms



In Pakistan fewer women are reported to use mobile phones because of the lack of approval from their families.²

Digital Literacy



In Bangladesh, India and Guatemala, fewer women use the internet because they cannot read and write.²

Economic Barriers



In Low and middle income countries an entry level phone takes up 25% of a woman's income.¹

Perceived Impact



In Ethiopia 20% of female respondents and 10% of male respondents perceive the Internet has a negative impact.²

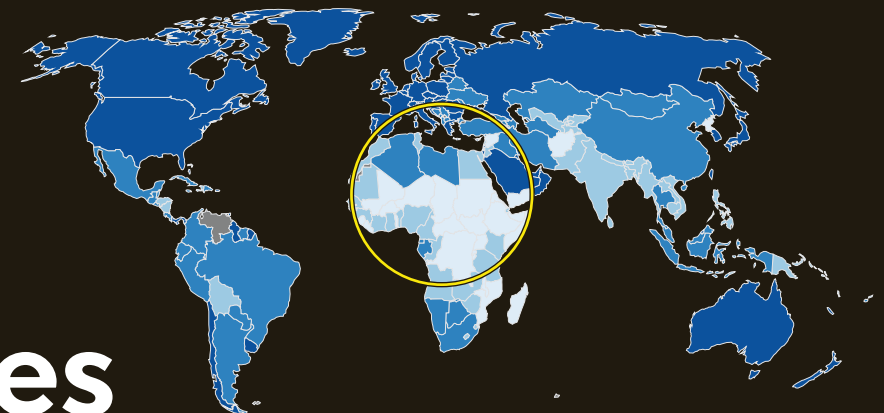
Highest Gender Gap Area

47.2%

Proportion of women who own mobile phones

20.9%

Proportion of women who use the Internet



Gender Inequality in Mobile Phones

Authors: Ximing Wang, Yvonne Darko

Data: ITU World Telecommunication ICT Indicators database; Natural Earth

Sources: 1. The State of Mobile Internet Connectivity 2022; 2. The Mobile Gender Gap Report 2023